

QUICK COMPARISON: EDGE VS. CHROME IN MEMORY EFFICIENCY		
Feature	Microsoft Edge	Google Chrome
Sleeping Tabs	✔ Yes (automatic)	⚠ Limited (manual or extension-based)
Efficiency Mode	✔ Yes (built-in)	✗ No direct equivalent
Memory Reduction	✔ Up to 32%	⚠ Limited impact with Memory Saver
CPU Usage Reduction	✔ Up to 37%	⚠ No official figures
Hardware Acceleration	✔ Optimized	✔ Available but less efficient
Low-End Device Performance	✔ Excellent	✗ Poor

How Microsoft Edge optimises memory usage better than Chrome?

Edge pulls off some impressive tricks to make memory management smoother and more efficient. Unlike Chrome, which keeps every active tab running in the background, Edge actively optimises resource allocation, ensuring a snappier and more responsive browsing experience. Let's dive into the key features that make this possible.

Sleeping Tabs

One of Edge's best tricks is Sleeping Tabs – a feature that automatically snoozes inactive tabs, freeing up CPU and memory resources. Microsoft claims it can cut memory usage by up to 32% and reduce CPU load by 37%, meaning better performance and longer battery life.

Now, Chrome recently introduced “Memory Saver Mode,” which does something similar, but the implementation is clunkier and less seamless compared to Edge's effortless background optimisation. With Chrome, you either have to manually discard tabs or rely on extensions. Edge, on the other hand, just handles it for you.

Efficiency Mode

Another clever trick Edge has up its sleeve is Efficiency Mode. This kicks in when your device is running low on battery, dialling down background activity, lowering frame rates for videos, and deprioritising

non-essential processes. The result? Your laptop doesn't drain battery like a sieve.

Chrome doesn't really have an equivalent feature. Sure, there are some power-saving tweaks, but they're nowhere near as aggressive or effective as Edge's.

Real-world scenarios where Edge shines over Chrome

Let's be real – the best way to judge a browser isn't just by looking at features on paper. It's how it handles real-world, high-memory usage situations. And this is where Edge flexes its efficiency muscles.

1. Streaming Video

If you've ever watched a 4K video on Chrome and felt your laptop turn into a mini space heater, you're not imagining things. Chrome doesn't optimise video playback well, leading to unnecessary CPU and memory drain. Edge, however, uses hardware acceleration and codec optimisations to ensure smooth playback while consuming less power. Plus, it prioritises the tab you're actively watching, so even if you have 20 other tabs open, your video experience remains buttery smooth.

2. Browser Gaming

If you play browser-based games, Edge is a no-brainer. Chrome's high memory consumption can introduce input lag, causing stuttering and inconsistent performance.

Edge, on the other hand, has an improved JavaScript engine and a more resource-efficient architecture, making

games run noticeably smoother. Plus, Efficiency Mode keeps unnecessary background processes in check, giving you higher frame rates and a more responsive gaming experience.

3. Heavy Multitasking

We've all been there – dozens of tabs open for work, entertainment, and everything in between. Chrome treats each tab like a separate entity, which is great for stability but terrible for memory management. The result? Your system slows to a crawl.

Edge handles this much better. It actively prioritises active tabs and puts unused ones to sleep, ensuring you don't experience annoying slowdowns, even when juggling multiple tasks.

4. Low-Memory Devices

If you're using a budget laptop or an older PC with 4GB or less RAM, Chrome's memory-hungry nature can be frustrating. Edge, with its lighter footprint and smarter memory allocation, is far more forgiving. Even with several tabs open, it remains smooth and responsive, making it a solid choice for low-end hardware.

Edge vs. Chrome: Which browser manages memory better?

With its smart optimisations, Edge outshines Chrome in memory management. While Google has introduced Memory Saver Mode, it's still not as seamless or efficient as Edge's automatic background tuning. Edge doesn't just use less RAM – it also improves battery life, CPU efficiency, and overall system performance.

Final verdict – Edge is just smarter about memory

Once you experience Edge's memory management, it's tough to go back to Chrome. Google has tried to implement some fixes, but they don't quite match the seamless, behind-the-scenes efficiency of Edge.

It's faster, and more efficient, and honestly, it makes Chrome feel like a bloated resource hog. If you're tired of Chrome devouring your system's memory, it's time to make the switch. **d**